CASE STUDY 02 | OBSERVED SOURCE-HEALTH INCIDENT

TGA HTTP 520: failed source is an evidence gap

Problem

A TGA news source returned HTTP 520. A monitor that labels that run NO_CHANGE would suggest a successful check when the source was unavailable.

Observed BEACON run

The saved 27 September 2026 20:51:34 UTC run reported EVIDENCE_GAP. FDA Drugs, FDA Press, EMA News, MHRA Updates and CDSCO Alerts showed OK; TGA News showed SOURCE_FAILED / HTTP 520. New discovery signal count was zero and release was false. This historical run has not been rechecked for the present export.

Engineering response

Store source status, error and check time separately. Aggregate to EVIDENCE_GAP when any approved source fails. Do not promote discovery signals to validated regulatory change. The URL migration baseline bug was corrected, but TGA coverage remained an open gap in that run.

Proof and next action

The official TGA news listing identifies the relevant source. Reproduce a successful permitted TGA fetch, archive the bytes and verify document-level detection before claiming reliable TGA coverage. A 520 is not proof that TGA published no updates.

Case type: engineering incident. Historical saved state, not a current TGA status claim.